A STUDY IN HISTORY AND SPIRITUALITY

From the Holy Bible to the Holy Quran

A Historical Inquiry in the Shadow of the Original Light

Neelam P.J. Pradeep Jesudas, B.Th

JAI BHIM EDUCATIONAL CHARITABLE TRUST

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Preface

A Journey Toward the Original Light

In the long story of human civilisation, religions are far more than systems of worship. They are the searchings of the human soul and the witnesses to the relationship between God and humankind. This book, *From the Holy Bible to the Holy Quran*, is the fruit of a long journey I have made as a researcher and as one with an unquenchable passion for history.

Today we see a world divided by religion. Yet if we dig deep into the roots of the Abrahamic faiths, we find far more astonishing agreement than contradiction. In particular, the sublime truths about Jesus Christ (ʿĪsā) recorded in the Holy Quran, a book our Muslim brothers and sisters cherish more than life itself, are too often passed over lightly.

My purpose is to bring to light the spiritual mystery that lies between seeing Jesus merely as a prophet and the honour that both the Bible and the Quran give him as "the Word of God" (*Kalimatullah*). This book was not written to belittle any faith. Rather, it sets out, with evidence, the truths hidden in the pages of history, so as to help the reader recognise the Original Light of the God who created us.

In these pages we will not speak of spirituality alone. From the Dead Sea Scrolls to the blood of the martyrs shed in the Arabian desert, we will examine a wide range of historical evidence with careful reasoning.

I am fully confident that this book will be a new key for every reader who seeks the truth. For a true search always ends in freedom.

With love,

Neelam P.J. Pradeep Jesudas, B.Th

Author

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CHAPTER 1

The Roots of the Original Light



The summit of Mount Sinai (Jebel Musa). Nineteenth-century painting by Edward Thomas Daniell.

1.1 The Beginning of History

The creation of this universe is no accident; it is the design of a supremely exalted Light. Looking back across human history, from the first human being until today, every person has wandered in search of a Supreme Being. The first landmark on that search is the Abrahamic tradition. Judaism, Christianity and Islam all branch out from a single root: Abraham. What, then, is the truth that this root proclaims?

1.2 The Law of Moses: The Mirror of Righteousness

The first body of law that God gave to humankind was the Law of Moses. Given on Mount Sinai in 1446 BC, these commandments became a mirror for humanity. Just as a mirror shows the dirt on our face, the Law exposed the sin within the human heart.

The Law said, "Do this, and you shall live." But weak humanity could not keep those commandments perfectly. Right here it became certain that the world needed a Saviour, a Redeemer.

1.3 The Holy Bible: The Unaltered Word of God

Among our Muslim friends there is a widespread belief that "the Bible has been altered" (*taḥrīf*); many Islamic scholars today repeat the same claim in support of their arguments. But when we examine the matter historically, the truth turns out to be very different. As a work of historical inquiry, this book must show here just how weak that argument is in terms of logic.

The first argument: When the Quran was revealed in the seventh century, what did it say about the earlier scriptures? The Holy Quran itself presents Jesus as one who "confirms the scriptures that came before him" (Sura 3:3).

> "He has sent down upon you, [O Prophet,] the Book in truth, confirming what was before it. And He sent down the Torah and the Gospel." (Quran 3:3)

If the Quran confirmed that the Bible of the seventh century was true, then to say it was altered afterwards makes no sense. For by the fourth century AD, copies of the Bible had already spread throughout the world. Even if someone changed the text in one place, he could not change the thousands of copies scattered across the earth.

The second, historical, proof: the Dead Sea Scrolls, discovered in 1947. These date from the second century BC, and they demonstrate before our very eyes that the biblical text has remained unchanged for centuries. The Old Testament verses in these scrolls agree with the verses in today's Bible with 99% accuracy. This proves scientifically that the Bible is the genuine, true and unaltered scripture of the world.



A clay jar and lid of the type that preserved scrolls in the caves of Qumran. (The Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York)

1.4 The Uniqueness of Jesus: The Hidden Meaning in the Quran

The Quran names many prophets, from Adam to the Prophet Muhammad. Yet why should the birth of Jesus (ʿĪsā) alone take place without a father? In Quran 4:171, God calls Jesus "*Kalima*" (Word) and "*Rūḥ*" (Spirit).

A person's word is the expression of his thought; it cannot be separated from him. Jesus, the Word of God, is the self-expression of God. Are not the Spirit and the Word that come from God themselves divine in nature? If a person's spirit is equal to that person, then the truth is that Jesus, the Spirit of God, is equal to God.

1.5 The Power to Create and the Key to Eternal Life

If Jesus was an ordinary messenger, how did he come to possess the power to create?

> "I make for you out of clay the likeness of a bird, and I breathe into it, and it becomes a [living] bird by the permission of Allah." (Quran 5:110)

Many prophets in the world worked miracles. But no one other than Jesus performed the act of giving life to something lifeless (life-giving power). To give life is a quality that belongs to God the Creator alone. That Jesus possessed this authority is the greatest proof, offered by the Quran itself, that he is divine.

1.6 The Spiritual Summit: Slave or Child?

Islam calls the human being the "slave" (*'abd*) of God. A slave is bound to his master by rules. But Christianity alone calls the human being a "child of God."

This is the difference between love and law:

- **Law says:** "If you do wrong, you will be punished."
- **Love says:** "I will bear your punishment myself."

If God is a just Judge, He must punish sinful humanity. But because He is a loving Father, He did not wish to punish us; instead He laid that punishment on the cross, upon His only Son, Jesus Christ. This is the highest spirituality in the world.

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CHAPTER 2

The Christian Dawn of Arabia (AD 523–610)

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An ornamented page of the Garima Gospels, among the oldest surviving Ethiopian Christian manuscripts (Aksumite period).

2.1 The Shadow of the Cross across the Desert

Today the Arabian Peninsula is known above all as the birthplace of Islam. Yet before the seventh century, the influence of Christianity had sunk deep roots across the whole Arabian land. Large Christian communities lived especially in Yemen, in Najran, and along the Syrian frontier. They worshipped God in the Arabic language.

The "oneness of God" (*tawḥīd*, the belief that God is one) that Islam introduced was nothing new to Arabia. Jews and Christians had upheld this belief there for centuries.

2.2 The Martyrs of Najran: A Witness of Faith (AD 523)

An unforgettable dark page in Arabian history was written in AD 523. Dhu Nuwas, the Jewish king who ruled the city of Najran in Yemen, pressed the Christians there to convert to his religion. But they refused to abandon their faith in Jesus Christ.

In his rage the king dug a great trench and lit a fire in it. More than 20,000 Christians who would not deny Jesus were burned alive in that pit of fire. The Holy Quran records this sacrifice in its eighty-fifth chapter (Sura al-Burūj):

> "Destroyed were the People of the Trench [those who made the pit of fire], of the fire full of fuel... And they resented them for nothing except that they believed in Allah." (Quran 85:4–8)

It was the blood shed by these martyrs that sowed the seed of the revolt against idols in Arabia. These children of the cross stood as the first witnesses of the *īmān* (faith) that Islam praises.

2.3 Waraqa ibn Nawfal: The Scholar Who Gave Recognition (AD 610)

In AD 610, when the first message came to the Prophet Muhammad in the cave of Hira near Mecca, he was overcome with fear and confusion. The one who then comforted and guided him was a Christian scholar: Waraqa ibn Nawfal.

Waraqa ibn Nawfal was deeply learned in the Christian scriptures. When he heard what had happened to Muhammad, the words he spoke prophetically are among the most important in history:

> "What has come to you is the same Holy Spirit (*Nāmūs*) who came to Mūsā (Moses) and to ʿĪsā (Jesus)."

Without the testimony of this Christian scholar, it would have been hard for Muhammad even to understand his own experience. The historical truth is that the dawn of Islam in Mecca would not have been possible without the recognition of Christianity.

2.4 The Migration to Abyssinia: The Negus Who Gave Refuge (AD 615)

When the Muslims were persecuted by the Quraysh in Mecca, the place the Prophet Muhammad pointed to for their safety was a Christian nation.

In AD 615 the Prophet told his companions: "Go to Abyssinia (Ethiopia). There is a Christian king there (the Negus), under whom no one is wronged." When the Muslims stood in the court of the Negus, they recited the Quranic verses about Mary and Jesus. Hearing them, the Negus wept and drew a line on the ground with a stick. "The difference between your scripture and ours," he said, "is no more than this line."

It was the protection given by that Christian king that saved the Muslim community from destruction in its earliest days. This is why the Quran says of Christians:

> "And you will find the nearest of them in affection to the believers those who say, 'We are Christians'... That is because among them are priests and monks, and because they are not arrogant." (Quran 5:82)

2.5 The Najran Delegation: A Historic Meeting in the Mosque of Medina (AD 631)

One of the most surprising events in Islamic history took place in AD 631 (9 AH). A Christian delegation of sixty people came to Medina from the Najran region of Yemen. Among them were bishops and religious scholars.

When they arrived, the Prophet Muhammad lodged them in the mosque of Medina itself (al-Masjid an-Nabawī). When evening came, the Christians prepared to offer their worship. Some tried to stop them, but the Prophet Muhammad restrained them and gave permission: "Let them pray."

According to the historians, those Christians turned to the east inside the very mosque of Medina and worshipped Jesus Christ, making the sign of the cross. This event, in which worship with the cross was permitted inside a mosque, reveals the deep spiritual bond that existed between Christianity and Islam.

It was during this meeting that debates arose about the divinity of Jesus. As a result, many verses of the third chapter of the Holy Quran (Āl ʿImrān) were revealed.

2.6 *Kalimatullah*: The Mystery of the Word of God

Of the verses revealed after the debates with the Christians of Najran, the most important is Quran 4:171. It holds a great mystery about Jesus that our Muslim brothers and sisters need to reconsider.

> "The Messiah, ʿĪsā son of Maryam, was but a messenger of Allah and His word (*kalimatuhu*) which He directed to Maryam, and a spirit from Him (*rūḥun minhu*)." (Quran 4:171)

Two words are used here: "Word" and "Spirit." Let us look at each in turn.

Word (*Kalima*): According to the Quran, when God wills to create something, He says "*Kun*" ("Be"). But Jesus was not created as other human beings were; he himself is that "Word." A person's word is the expression of his mind; it cannot be separated from him. The Word of God is eternal and imperishable. Therefore Jesus, the Word of God, also stands beyond time.

Spirit (*Rūḥ*): When the Quran speaks of other human beings, it says that "spirit was breathed into them." But Jesus alone it describes as "a spirit from God" (*rūḥun minhu*). This confirms that he came forth directly from the divine nature.

John 1:1 in the Bible says the same thing plainly:

> "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God." (John 1:1)

2.7 The Holy and Sinless One (*al-Zakiyy*)

The Holy Quran records that all its prophets, being human, asked God's forgiveness for their sins. For example, the Quran mentions Adam, Ibrāhīm, Mūsā and the Prophet Muhammad seeking God's pardon.

But Jesus Christ (ʿĪsā) alone the Quran calls "a pure son" (*ghulāman zakiyyā*) (Quran 19:19). The Arabic word *zakiyy* means "spotless" or "one who knows no sin."

A sinner cannot intercede for another sinner. Only Jesus, who came sinless from birth as the Word of God, is qualified to intercede for humankind. This is why Jesus stands out as unique above all the prophets that Islam presents, and rises as the Saviour of the world.

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CHAPTER 3

The Cross and Redemption: A Historical Truth



The Garden Tomb in Jerusalem: an ancient tomb cut into the rock.

3.1 The Love That Conquered Death

The most debated, and at the same time the most sublime, event in spiritual history is the death of Jesus Christ on the cross. Many Islamic scholars put forward the view that "Jesus was not crucified; someone was substituted for him." But as a work of historical inquiry, this book must look closely at why the crucifixion is an undeniable historical fact, and why it happened.

The cross is not merely an instrument of punishment; it is a bridge built between the sin of humanity and the justice of God.

3.2 Death on the Cross: The Historical Evidence (AD 30–33)

The death of Jesus is not a report found only in the Bible. Renowned secular historians who lived in that era also recorded it:

- **Cornelius Tacitus:** This Roman historian, writing around AD 115, states clearly that "Christus suffered the death penalty during the reign of Tiberius at the hands of Pontius Pilate."
- **Flavius Josephus:** This Jewish historian recorded that Jesus was crucified and that his disciples continued to follow him.

When an event is attested historically by so much evidence, to deny it is contrary to science.

3.3 The Mystery of "Death" in the Holy Quran

We must look carefully at the verses in the Quran that speak of the death of Jesus.

> "[Mention] when Allah said, 'O ʿĪsā, indeed I will cause you to die (*mutawaffīka*) and raise you to Myself...'" (Quran 3:55)

The Arabic word used here, *mutawaffīka*, means "to cause to die" or "to take back in full." Likewise, the words Jesus Christ spoke prophetically while still an infant are recorded in the Quran:

> "And peace is on me the day I was born, and the day I die (*yawma amūtu*), and the day I am raised alive." (Quran 19:33)

These verses firmly confirm both the death of Jesus and his resurrection.

3.4 Why Was a Sacrifice Necessary? (The Doctrine of Atonement)

Here an important question asked by our Muslim brothers and sisters arises: "If God wished, could He not simply forgive? Why is a sacrifice needed?"

There is a simple logic to answer this. God is a just Judge. If you commit a crime and stand in court, and the judge simply lets you go "on the basis of love," he cannot be a good judge. Justice demands a penalty.

Humanity sinned, and the penalty for that sin is death. But God loved humanity. So He found a way to bring justice and love together in one place. That way is "atonement" (substitution).

Only one who has never sinned can bear the sins of others. As Quran 6:164 says, "No bearer of burdens will bear the burden of another." That applies to sinful human beings. But Jesus, who came as the Word of God (*Kalima*) and as the Holy One (*Zakiyy*), took upon himself the entire sin of humankind and was sacrificed on the cross.

3.5 The Cross: The Summit of Sacrifice

Islam is a faith that honours sacrifice. But what is the greatest sacrifice in the world? It is no sacrifice for someone to be punished for his own wrongdoing. True sacrifice is a father accepting the punishment for the wrongdoing of his children.

The words Jesus spoke as he hung on the cross reveal his divine love:

> "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing." (Luke 23:34)

A love that intercedes even for those who were killing him cannot come from an ordinary human being. This is the love of God. And it is through this love that Jesus Christ becomes the Saviour of the world.

3.6 The Hero Who Conquered Death: The Resurrection

It is not enough for a saviour to die for sins; he must also be the conqueror of death. That Jesus Christ died on the cross, was buried, and rose alive on the third day is the very foundation of Christianity.

The Holy Quran confirms this with great subtlety:

> "And [peace is on me] the day I am raised alive." (Quran 19:33)

Historically, the tomb of Jesus is empty today. If Jesus had not risen, his disciples would never have risked their lives to spread this message throughout the world. If disciples who once ran away for fear of death dared to face that same death after seeing Jesus alive, then the logical conclusion is that a tremendous truth, the resurrection, had taken place.

3.7 *As-Sāʿa*: The Sign of the Last Day

There is one truth that all our Muslim friends believe: that Jesus will return to the earth. But why must he come? Neither the Prophet Muhammad nor the other prophets will come back; why should Jesus alone return?

The Holy Quran gives an astonishing answer:

> "And indeed, he [ʿĪsā] is a sign of the Hour, so be not in doubt of it." (Quran 43:61)

The word used here for "sign" is *ʿilmun*. That is to say, the authority to determine the end of the world and the authority to pronounce judgement have

been entrusted to Jesus. He will not come as a religious leader, but as "the righteous Judge."

3.8 The Mediator: The Bridge between Humanity and God

God is holy; humanity is sinful. How can an impure human being reach a holy God? This is precisely where a "mediator" is needed.

According to the Quran, no one can intercede on the Day of Judgement. But Jesus, who came as the Word of God (*Kalima*) and the Spirit of God (*Rūḥ*), has already borne humanity's punishment on the cross, and so he has received full authority to intercede for us. The Bible says:

> "For there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus." (1 Timothy 2:5)

3.9 Conclusion: The Freedom the Cross Reveals

Dear Muslim friends, the cross is not a symbol of defeat; it is a banner of victory. No one can satisfy the justice of God by his own works, prayers or fasting. But by believing in the sacrifice of Jesus Christ, a person receives complete freedom from his sins.

Laws will make you slaves; but the love of Jesus will make you sons and daughters. Whoever accepts in his heart that "Jesus is my Saviour" need not fear death, for the One who conquered death is with him.

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CHAPTER 4

The Three Faiths Compared: Why Is Christianity Unique?



The Return of the Prodigal Son (Luke 15), Rembrandt, c. 1668: a celebrated portrayal of a father's love.

4.1 The Burden of the Law and the Freedom of Grace

In spiritual history, Judaism, Christianity and Islam, the so-called Abrahamic religions, come from one root, yet they differ greatly in the path by which they bring a person to God. A Muslim brother believes that he can reach God only by following the "laws" (*sharīʿa*) throughout his life. Christianity, however, offers a sublime relationship that goes beyond these laws.

4.2 Judaism: The Mirror of Righteousness

In 1446 BC, Judaism received the Ten Commandments through Moses. It is "the religion of law," and its purpose is to show how weak human beings are.

- **The Law said:** "Do this, and you shall live."
- **And humanity replied:** "I try to do it, but I keep failing."

Judaism gave a person the awareness that he is a sinner, but it did not give him the power to be set free from that sin.

4.3 Islam: A Reordering of Morality

Islam, which arrived in the seventh century AD, presented the laws of Judaism again with some changes. It is "a religion of lifestyle." It gave humanity five duties (the Five Pillars) and many moral codes.

The logic of Islam runs: "Do many good deeds; if on your scales the good outweighs the bad, you will receive forgiveness."

There is a serious problem here. God's scales do not work on the reckoning that 51% goodness is enough; because He is holy, He requires 100% holiness. Just as milk with a single drop of poison in it becomes wholly poisonous, so a person who has committed even a small sin is guilty in the sight of God.

4.4 Christianity: The Dignity of Relationship

This is where Christianity differs completely from the other two faiths. Christianity is not a "religion"; it is a "relationship" between the Father and His child (the religion of relationship).

Other religions call a person the "slave" (*'abd*) of God. But Christianity calls a person the "child" of God.

- A slave works for his master out of duty; but a son obeys his father out of love.
- A slave fears the whip if he does wrong; a son is concerned about grieving his father.

4.5 Grace: Love Given to the Undeserving

The word "grace" may be new to our Muslim friends. Grace is the incomparable love God shows us while we are still undeserving.

- **Justice:** receiving the punishment for the sin we have committed.
- **Mercy:** not receiving the punishment for the sin we have committed.
- **Grace:** having the punishment we deserve removed, and being freely given heavenly life.

This is the reason Quran 19:19 calls Jesus "the Holy One." Only one who is holy can intercede for an undeserving sinner.

4.6 Salvation by Works, or Salvation by Faith?

Islam teaches that one may enter Paradise through "works." Christianity teaches that one enters heaven through "faith." Why is this?

Because however many good deeds a person does, they are like a stained garment. Our good deeds cannot wash away our past sins. But when we believe in the sacrifice that Jesus Christ offered for us on the cross, God credits us with his righteousness.

An illustration: Suppose you owe a debt at a shop. Today you may pay cash for what you buy, but the old debt remains just as it was. Someone has to settle that old debt. The only one who has settled the old debt called sin is Jesus!

4.7 The Father's Heart of God: From Fear to Love

When our Muslim brothers and sisters call God "Allah," they take pride in His ninety-nine names (*al-Asmā' al-Ḥusnā*). Names such as *ar-Raḥmān* (the Most Gracious) and *al-Malik* (the King) speak of God's might. Yet there is one relational name the human soul longs for that appears nowhere among these names: "Father."

Nowhere in the Holy Quran does God call Himself Father; instead He identifies the human being as His "slave" (*ʿabd*). But the Bible grants us the right to call God "Abba, Father."

An illustration: When the subjects of a king do wrong, he punishes them according to the law. But when a son does wrong, his father corrects him and grieves for him himself. God does not see us as His slaves; He sees us as His lost children. The greatness of Christianity lies in this difference of perspective.

4.8 The Help of the Holy Spirit: Change from Within

In Islam, a person must rely on his own willpower to keep from sinning. Christianity goes a step further and promises: "I know your weakness; I give you the Holy Spirit to change you from within."

We have already seen that Quran 4:171 calls Jesus "a spirit from Him (from God)." This Spirit is not mere wind; it is the direct power of God, which transforms the human heart and creates a hatred of sin.

Explanation: Other religions lay down laws from the outside: "Do not do this." But Jesus Christ gives the power from within to "do what is good." This is the true spiritual revolution.

4.9 The Fear of Death: Where Is There Certainty?

A great question troubles many of our Muslim friends: "Are the good deeds I have done enough? Will God forgive me?" No one can be certain of his salvation until the Day of Judgement comes.

But Christianity gives "assurance of salvation." For salvation does not rest on our works (deeds); it rests on the sacrifice that Jesus Christ accomplished on the cross.

> "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." (Romans 8:1)

This assurance governs a Christian not through fear but through gratitude. Out of thankfulness that God has saved him, he strives to live without sin.

4.10 Conclusion: Why Is Christianity the Highest?

To put it briefly:

- **Judaism** pointed out sin (diagnosis).
- **Islam** prescribed ways to avoid sin (precaution).
- **Christianity** heals the sinner and reunites him with God (cure and reunion).

Going to a hospital and receiving only a prescription (the law) will not cure the disease. What we need is the Physician (Jesus) who prepared the medicine and paid for it with his own life.

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CHAPTER 5

Spiritual Clarity against the Background of History



Ancient Nicaea (modern İznik, Turkey): the city's historic church of Hagia Sophia.

5.1 The Crusades and Spiritual Understanding

The Crusades are seen in history as the great clash between Christianity and Islam. Many Islamic scholars portray them as Christian violence. But as a work of historical inquiry, this book must state one truth aloud: "The Crusades were political; they were contrary to the teachings of Jesus Christ."

Jesus Christ never told anyone to take up the sword. He taught, "Love your enemy." Rather, the Crusades arose as a counter-strike when Islamic expansion

was advancing at the point of the sword. The spiritual clarity we must note here is this: the wrongs people commit in the name of a religion do not diminish the founder of that religion, Jesus.

5.2 The Council of Nicaea (AD 325): A Historical Clarification

One accusation our Muslim friends often raise is that "Jesus was turned into God at the Council of Nicaea in AD 325." This is historical ignorance.

The Council of Nicaea did not make Jesus God. On the contrary, it stands as evidence that from the very beginning (from the first century AD) Christians had worshipped Jesus as God. When a man named Arius questioned the divinity of Jesus, the whole Christian world came together and affirmed that "Jesus has been the Word of God from the beginning." Quran 4:171 echoes this very thing when it calls him *Kalimatullah*, the Word of God.

5.3 The Hidden Miracles of History

Many Islamic historians accept the miracles of Jesus. But what was the purpose of those miracles?

- The other prophets worked miracles by "praying" to God.
- But Jesus worked miracles by his own authority: "I say to you, get up and walk."

When Quran 3:49 and 5:110 list the miracles of Jesus, the phrase "by the permission of God" (*bi-idhnillāh*) appears. This is true, because the Father and the Son (the Word) are one. The Son does nothing apart from the Father's will. But the historical truth is that the authority resided within Jesus himself.

5.4 A Worldwide Transformation: A Witness of History

The Roman Empire persecuted Christians cruelly and threw them to the lions. Yet, without any weapon, with love as its only weapon, Christianity brought that mighty empire to bow beneath the cross of Jesus.

How was this possible? If this were a religion made by a man, it would have perished. But it was born of the power of a God who conquered death and rose again. This is why Christianity was influential in Arabia in the time of the Prophet Muhammad. And it was in view of that influence that the Quran in many places called Christians "rightly guided."

5.5 Conclusion: The Hero of History

History, in English, has been called "His-Story," His story. That "He" is Jesus Christ. He alone divided time itself into two, BC and AD.

If our Muslim friends go searching through their own history, at every step they will find the shadow of Jesus Christ. One cannot seek the light while turning away from that shadow, for that light is Jesus Christ himself.

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CHAPTER 6

Conclusion: Jesus, the Saviour of the World



A beam of light breaking through the clouds. "I am the light of the world" (John 8:12).

6.1 The End of the Search: The Truth Will Set You Free

Through this study we have travelled many historical paths, beginning from the roots of Abraham, through the laws of Moses, the reliability of the Bible, the Christian background of Arabia, and the redemption of the cross. Now we stand before one supremely important question: "Who is Jesus (Īsā), the exalted figure to whom Islam points?"

Our Muslim friends respect Jesus and love him. But it is because they keep him shut inside the cage of "prophet" that their spiritual thirst remains unquenched.

6.2 The "Mysterious" Leader of the Quran

Anyone who reads the Quran deeply will notice one truth. All the other prophets died and returned to dust. But Jesus alone God "raised to Himself" (Quran 3:55).

- Why should he alone be alive?
- Why should he alone return to pronounce judgement?

Because he is not only a messenger; he is the direct self-expression (the Word) of the God who sends the message. A man does not call his messenger back to himself; but he does gather his son (his Word) back to himself.

6.3 Good News for Our Muslim Brothers and Sisters

Dear brothers and sisters, Quran 10:94 contains a remarkable command:

> "So if you are in doubt about what We have revealed to you [the Quran], then ask those who have been reading the Scripture [the Bible] before you." (Quran 10:94)

If you open that earlier scripture today, what awaits you there is not a religion but a Father who loves you. The "Allah" presented by Islam may seem One to be feared; but the "Father" revealed by Jesus Christ is full of love.

To accept Jesus as Saviour is not to hate Islam; rather, it is to arrive at the destination (Jesus) of the very path along which Islam leads you.

6.4 The Final Judgement and Eternal Life

You may fear that on the Last Day (the Day of *Qiyāma*) there will be no one to intercede for you. But Jesus Christ has already interceded for you. The blood he shed on the cross has become the atonement for all your sins, past, present and future.

There is only one thing you need to do:

> "Jesus, I believe that you are the Word of God, and that you are the Saviour who died and rose again for me."

Simply make this confession in your heart. This one act of faith will raise you from the status of a "slave" to that of a "child of God."

6.5 Conclusion: The Call of the Original Light

As you finish reading this book, you will feel a peace being born in your heart. That peace is the gift Jesus Christ gives you. History may change and nations may fall, but the words of Jesus, "I am the way, and the truth, and the life" (John 14:6), will never change.

Rest in the shadow of Jesus Christ, the Original Light. The truth will set you free!

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Bibliography and Sources

The ideas and historical events presented in this book are based on the following primary and secondary sources:

1. Sacred Texts

- **The Holy Bible:** Old and New Testaments (especially the Gospel of John and the Epistle to the Romans).
- **The Holy Quran:** especially the commentaries on Sura Āl ʻImrān, Sura an-Nisāʾ, Sura Maryam and Sura al-Burūj.

2. Historical Records

- **The Annals of Tacitus:** the record in which a Roman historian of the first century AD noted the crucifixion of Jesus.
- **Flavius Josephus:** *Antiquities of the Jews*, the writings of the Jewish historian.
- **The Dead Sea Scrolls:** research data on the ancient biblical manuscripts discovered in 1947.

3. Islamic Traditions

- **Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī and Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim (hadith collections):** records of the life of the Prophet Muhammad and of his meetings with Christian delegations.
- **Tafsīr Ibn Kathīr:** the celebrated historical commentary on the verses of the Quran.

- **The Migration to Abyssinia:** accounts by early Islamic historians such as Ibn Isḥāq.

4. Archaeological Findings

- Research reports on early Christian churches discovered in the Middle East and on the historical monuments of the city of Najran.

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With love always,

Neelam P.J. Pradeep Jesudas, B.Th

Author

A HIDDEN HISTORY... A TRUTH UNCOVERED!

Three faiths branching from one root; three scriptures that each claim to journey toward the one God. What is the mysterious point that connects them?

Why does the Holy Quran honour Jesus (ʿĪsā) so highly, as "the Word of God" (*Kalimatullah*) and "the Spirit of God" (*Ruhullah*)? Why was a Christian scholar needed at the dawn of the Prophet Muhammad's mission? What did the blood of the martyrs of Najran achieve?

This book is not merely a religious debate. It is a gospel document that helps the reader recognise, historically and logically, the exalted figure who stands behind the Quranic verses our Muslim brothers and sisters revere: Jesus Christ.

It is a historical journey that calls you out of the grip of the Law and into the freedom of grace.

"You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free."

— John 8:32

Neelam P.J. Pradeep Jesudas, B.Th

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